



COMM200 PERSUASIVE SPEECH

Republic Is Not Democracy

Voting without citizen power is oligarchy.

A system can keep the democratic costume while stripping citizens of command.

Source: Wikimedia Commons, A.Savin, CC BY-SA 3.0

THE CORE DECEPTION

A ballot is not sovereignty.

Elections can crown decision-makers while citizens lose command over law, agenda, and accountability.

Source: Freedom House, 2025

Voting Is Not Rule

- Res publica claims the public interest.
- Officeholders decide what that interest means.
- Citizens choose rulers, then vanish from power.
- No agenda power means no sovereignty.

Aristotle / Rousseau / Dahl



CLAIMED SOURCE

Citizens

FILTER OF POWER

Parties

REAL COMMAND

Parliament

Policy is drawn after the people have already been reduced to approval.

ARGUMENT 2

Representation Replaces the Citizen

First we vote. Then power leaves
us.

Rule by Networks, Not Citizens

Oligarchy does not need a mask forever. It needs access, money, and gatekeepers.

- Party machines decide who enters.
- Economic power buys influence.
- Media visibility manufactures attention.
- Appointments protect the system.

Scored cleaner than Greece

Rwanda	58
Qatar	58
Saudi Arabia	57
Oman	52
Malaysia	52
Greece	50

Access becomes the hidden constitution: who enters, who is heard, who is protected, and who is abandoned.

LEGITIMACY CRISIS

Citizens Cannot Rule in the Dark

When surveillance, pressure, and
silence expand, sovereignty
becomes theater.

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Press freedom rank / Greece

- Press pressure
- Wiretapping scandal
- SLAPP intimidation
- Managed visibility

SATISFACTION

Return Power to the Citizen Body

Referendum. Initiative. Recall. Audit. Justice. The people must become an institution.

Oligarchy or Democracy

Republic as Oligarchy

- Voting without command
- Party rule
- Elite networks
- Hidden bargains
- Citizens without power

Democracy of Citizens

- The citizen body rules
- Policy before persons
- Recall of officials
- Public audit
- Justice under citizen control

Stop Asking to Be Represented

- Name oligarchy when power leaves citizens.
- Demand citizen-initiated referenda.
- Demand legislative initiative from below.
- Make officials recallable.
- Put corruption under public audit.

Democracy begins when citizens rule after election day.



SOURCES

References

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